

The Connor Murphy Story I'll Never Forget

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 17, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R7AbJjQ3WXw> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter eulogizes Connor Murphy, using their shared obsession with macro tracking as a launchpad to argue that extreme, failure-proof effort — not shortcuts — is the only path to exceptional results in fitness, wealth, and relationships.

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Remembering Connor Murphy 0:00

- Brandon lost Connor Murphy "this time last week" — describes him as someone he was "close with, the homie"
- They worked closely together for "a number of years"
 - Brandon's team managed Connor's entire fitness business
 - "We really did some great things together until he took his career and life in another direction"
- The video is framed as a tribute, using Connor's example to teach a broader lesson about extreme discipline

The Food Scale Moment & Macro Discipline 0:25

- One of their first hangouts was at a nice restaurant in Texas, where Connor was going to college
- When the food arrived, Brandon pulled out a food scale — he has tracked everything he eats for **over two decades**
 - Connor pulled out a food scale at the same moment
 - They looked at each other: "Oh shit" — because it is rare even within the fitness industry

- Connor's level of tracking was extreme: **he weighed his condiments**
 - Ketchup, barbecue sauce — everything went on the scale
- Brandon asked Connor: "What do you do on a day when maybe you don't get enough protein — do you make up for it the next day?"
 - Connor's response (serious, almost bewildered): "Yeah, that doesn't happen. That's not a thing. I'm gonna hit my macros and my calories every day."
 - Brandon's reaction: "That's what the f*** I'm talking about."
- Both were **natural athletes at the time** — Connor didn't drink, never smoked weed, nothing
 - Despite being natural, both received heavy accusations of steroid use
 - Brandon notes he later went on TRT just before turning 40 (age/medical reason); Connor's path diverged separately

🚫 Stop Looking for Shortcuts 1:58

- The core accusation Brandon makes at his audience:

"You f***ers are always trying to see how much you can get away with. Instead of seeing how much of your potential you can bring to the surface, you're trying to see what's the least you can do and still get results."

- He is not opposed to optimization — "if you do find a cheat code or a shortcut, take it. Don't make s*** more difficult than it needs to be."
 - BUT: you must have the basics locked down first
 - "You don't deserve a shortcut if you don't have the basics down"
- Wrong question: "What's the least I can do?" / "What's the 80/20?"
 - His verdict: "You don't deserve to 80/20 s. *Most of you are approaching your goals like pies.*"
- If Connor's level of discipline is sustained for a decade, "how can you lose?"

🐛 The Bug Fumigation Framework 3:32

- Analogy: You see a bug in your house
 - Option A — try to step on it, use a fly swatter, throw something at it
 - Problem: you might miss
 - Option B — fumigate the whole house or call an exterminator
 - Result: **guaranteed to work**
- Most people approach their goals like Option A — just enough effort to maybe hit the target
- The reframe: stop asking "What do I have to do to accomplish this goal?"
 - Instead ask: **"How much effort would I have to put in to make failure impossible?"**

- "That's a way, way, way more intense method of going about your goal. If you do that, you'll win."
- Supporting story — guitar lesson:
 - Brandon was good enough to be paid to play guitar at a singer's gig
 - His teacher had him work on complex jazz chords (seventh chords, ninth chords)
 - When Brandon got it once and celebrated, his teacher said:
 - **"Amateurs practice till they get it right. Professionals practice till they can't get it wrong."**
 - A professional ingrains the muscle memory so deeply that doing it wrong becomes impossible
- Supporting story — Larry Bird (referred to as "Larry Burke" in the transcript):
 - Had to film a McDonald's commercial requiring him to **miss** a free throw
 - It took many attempts to miss because he had practiced so much that missing was hard
 - "That's what I'm talking about. You got to put in so much effort that you missing the goal would be hard."

No One Cares About Your Excuses 6:16

- Brandon once wanted to be a doctor — realized the schooling and cost weren't worth it to him and made peace with that
 - The wrong response: seeing a doctor and calling it "easy" or "cheating" — that's how haters are born
 - Haters = people who weren't willing to do the work, so they became cynical and bitter
 - "It's hard to succeed when you're living in that environment — in your head. It's like a cloud of hate over you and it's hard to see the sun past those clouds."
- Some people genuinely have fewer advantages — his response: "work harder than them. Don't nobody give a f*** about your circumstances."
- Two blunt analogies for why excuses are worthless:
 - You can't walk into a Rolls-Royce dealership and explain your dad wasn't around and you grew up in the hood as payment — "You can't pay your bills with that."
 - You can't tell an attractive woman you don't have a six-pack but she should be with you anyway because someone else had advantages you didn't
- "Excuses are not a currency accepted for the exchange of goods and services."

The Takeaway: Make Failure Impossible 8:35

- **The action plan — step by step:**
 - Pick one goal from each of the three major categories: **health, wealth/money, and relationships**
 - For each goal, build a plan that requires so much effort that failure would be impossible
 - Evaluate the plan honestly: "Do I want it this bad?"
 - Execute — because your behavior after making the plan tells the truth about how bad you want it
 - "You can lie to all of us. You can lie to everyone else. But you can't f*** yourself. You'll know."
- What to expect when executing at this level:

- People will say: "You're crazy. Relax. You're doing too much. Everything in moderation."
- Brandon's label for that: **"The battlecries of the mediocre"**
- "If no one's telling you you're going too hard, that means you're not going hard enough — because it looks normal to them."
- On fear: going after the impossible-to-fail plan removes fear because you know you can't fail
- On the question "What if you put in that kind of effort and still fail?":
 - "It doesn't happen. That's not how it works."
- The average American baseline Brandon uses as a warning:
 - Average American is **17 pounds overweight**
 - Average American has **less than \$1,000 in savings**
 - "They may be happy — but we don't want the same outcomes."
- Extreme success requires extreme action — "There is no version of reality where it can happen different."
- Timeline: **"90 days from now, your whole life can change."**

Free Tool: The RIP Road Map [11:19](#)

- For fitness goals specifically, Brandon offers a free tool: **the RIP Road Map** (link in description)
- How it works:
 - Click the link and enter height, weight, age, and upload a photo of yourself
 - An AI analyzes the photo and inputs
 - You state your goal: build muscle, get ripped, get abs to show, etc.
 - Input gender (women can use it too)
 - Output: exact body fat percentage, how much body fat you're holding, and **exactly how many calories and how much protein you need daily** to reach your goal
 - Carbs and fats are adjustable via a slider (high carb/low fat, low carb/high fat, or balanced) — protein stays fixed
 - Also provides a week-by-week expectation timeline if you follow the plan
- Cost: **100% free**